Unani at Glance

The word 'Unani' is derived from a Greek word 'Ionian'. 'Tibb' means the knowledge of the state of the human body in health and illness. Unani medicine strives to find the best possible ways by which a person can lead a healthy life. The Unani system of medicine is one of the oldest and most acceptable systems of medicine practiced in India and in many parts of the world.Hippocrates practiced it over 2500 years ago.

Unani Medicine includes a great deal of ancient Egyptian medicine as well as important components of the ancient Mesopotamian traditions. Thus, it can be said that many aspects of Graeco-Arabic Medicine are even more than 6000 years old.Graeco-Arabic Medicine is being practiced as a traditional medicine in Europe,the Middle East and the Asian subcontinent. In the Middle East and in the Asian Subcontinent, Graeco-Arabic Medicine continues to serve millions of people as traditional medicine. Further, as modern medicine also originated from the ancient Graeco-Arabic medicine, hence new scientific concepts can readily be integrated into its practices. Thus, Graeco-Arabic Medicine has great potentials for the future health care.

The first physician of the system was Asclepedeus who established few principles of medicine.Hippocrates put forward the Humoral theory, which formed the basic framework of Unani medicine. His era marked the beginning of the Golden Period of the Unani system of medicine. He also initiated the concept of hospital and built the first hospital of the world in Hamas (Egypt) after travelling around the globe to find a suitable place.

Another renowned physician was Galen who played a major role in propagation of the system far and wide.A few important texts of the system include Kitab-ul-Hashaish (1st Century B.C), Kamil-Us-Sana (10th century A.D.), Canon of Medicine (11th century A.D).

The Unani pharmacopoeia Committee was constituted in 1964,consisting of Unani experts and scientist with a view to maintain uniformity in the standards of drugs and to prescribe standards for compound formulations and for identity, purity, efficacy and quality of the drugs. Pharmacopoeial Laboratory of Indian Medicine at Ghaziabad was established under Government of India to workout standards and drug testing for Indian System of Medicine at national level.Central Council of Indian Medicine, a statutory body was established for laying down standards and for maintaining uniform standard of education in the Indian System of Medicine including Unani and to regulate the practices in Indian System of Medicine.

In order to develop high standards of education and research in Unani Medicine at national level a National Institute of Unani Medicine has been established at Bangalore

in 1983 in collaboration with the Govt. of Karnataka.In addition to these developments Central Council for Research in Indian Medicine was established in 1969.During 1978 these Council were bifurcated into separate Central Councils viz Central Council for Research in Unani Medicine which was established in 1979, with a view to initiate, guide, aid, develop, coordinate scientific research in different aspects of fundamental and applied Unani System of Medicine.

There are 11 Regional Research Institutes, 7 Clinical Research Units,1 Literary Research Units,2 Survey and Cultivation of Medicinal Plants Unit,7 Drug Standardisation Research Unit.At present, there are 31 Unani colleges in India offering graduate education and four colleges offering Postgraduate education.

Umoor-e-Tabiyyah (Basic Components of Life)

The human body is a complex structure comprising of seven ***Umoor-e-tabiyyah*** i.e. basic elements. These
are ***Arkan*** (Elements), ***Mizaj*** (Temperament), ***Akhlaat*** (Humors) ***Aza***(Organs), ***Arwah*** (Pneuma), ***Quwa*** (Faculties), and ***Af'aal*** (Functions).For the proper functioning of the body, all the above-mentioned components should be present and work in coordination with each other.

Ideology

The Unani System of medicine is based on the Humoral Theory. According to it,there are four humors in the body i.e. ***Dam*** (Blood), ***Balgham*** (Phlegm), ***Safra*** (Yellow Bile), and ***Sauda*** (Black bile).These are generated in liver by the nutrient components of the ingested food and liquids. There is a strong relationship between a body fluid and its associated humor, so any imbalance in a humor will also cause changes in the composition and properties of its associated body fluid.Health is a state of body in which all the humors are in equilibrium both in quantity and quality ,any alteration in the equilibrium leads to disease.Unani medicine describes the concept of Tabiyat (Medicatrix naturae),which is a supreme planner of the body , to create the healthy environment within the body and prepare to fight against the disease.If ***tabiyat*** is strong, then a man does not suffer from a disease easily, if it weakens, a man becomes prone to disease easily.

Essentials of Health

Unani medicine has also given great importance to the prevention of the disease and promotion of health than cure.There is an influence of surroundings and ecological conditions on health of human being. There are six factors, which are essential for the maintenance of good health called ***Asbab-e- Sittah Zaruriah***. These essentials are as follows:

1. ***Hawa-e-Muheet*** (Fresh Air)

2. ***Makool-o-Mashroob***(Food and Drink)

3. ***Harkat-wa-Sukoon-e-Badania***(Body Movement and Repose)

4. ***Harkat-wa-Sukoon-e-Nafsania***(Mental Movement and Repose)

5. ***Naum-o-Yaqzah***(Sleep and Wakefulness)

6. ***Ehtibas-o-Istafraagh***(Retention and Evacuation)

Diagnosis

Firstly, the practitioner takes a full case history. This has many aspects, but generally includes observation of the patient under 10 physical parameters of mizaj to determine the Mizaj of an individual.the physician also observes, the pulse (***Nabz***), which often takes a little time, as the physician does not just take the pulse rate, but also looks for subtle changes in the pulse that may indicate present or threatening health conditions. In addition, the practitioner may press reflexes and examine the urine (***Baul***) and stool (***Baraz***) of the patient.

Principles of Treatment

In Unani system of medicine, treatment is based on temperament and humors. In diseased condition,there is imbalance in body temperament and humors. Therefore, Unani physicians make all efforts for the correction of temperament and balance in humors. Every humor has a specific temperament as described earlier e.g. hot, wet, cold, and dry. So, the drug used for the treatment should posses an opposite temperament than that of diseased humor, resulting in normalization of temperament. A disease, which is cold in nature, can be cured by a drug, which has hot temperament.

Methods of Treatment

Treatment is divided into four parts:

1. *Ilaj-Bil-Ghiza*(Dietotherapy)-Treatment through Diet

2. *Ilaj-Bil-Tadbeer*(Regimental therapy)- Treatment through certain procedures, tools and equipments.

3. *Ilaj-Bil-Dawa*(Pharmacotherapy)- Treatment through Drugs/Medicines, which are of Plant, Mineral or Animal Origin.

4. *Ilaj-Bil-Yad*(Surgery)- Treatment through Minor /Major Operative Procedures.

Treatment depends on degree of variation from the normal healthy condition. Dietotherapy is advised if the variation is of low degree, but if the variation is such that Dietotherapy alone cannot correct it, then Regimental therapy is advised and in Pharmacotherapy drugs are used according to the stage of the disease. In addition, Dietotherapy is also advised along with pharmacotherapy as per the temperament of

the disease to cure the disease in a short period, so, the disease can be cured easily. Regimental therapy and Surgery are also advised when Dietotherapy and Pharmacotherapy fail to restore the health of a patient.

Unani traditional medicine formulations till date included in the Traditional Knowledge Digital Library are 1,75,150.





Principles of Unani

The Unani system recognises that disease is an unnatural process and symptoms of a disease are body's reaction to noxious factors from its surroundings. The chief function of the physician is to aid the natural force of the body, which is termed as Tabi'at (Physis). Unani medicine is based on four Humor theories, which are Dam (Blood), Balgham (Phlegm), Safra (Yellow bile) and Sauda (black bile). The body has the power of self-control to maintain an optimum balance of these humors, which is called as Quwwat-e-Mudabbirah-e-Badan (Medicatrix Naturae).

The essential constituents and the working principles of the body, according to Unani system of medicine, can be classified into seven main groups:

1. Arkaan (Elements)

2. Mizaj (Temperament)

3. Akhlaat (Humors)

4. A'za (Organs)

5. Arwaah. (Pneuma)

6. Quwa (Faculties of Power)

7. Afa'al (Actions)

Unani system of medicine believes that Arkaan (elements), which are broadly divided in four categories i.e. Earth (Arz), Water (Maa'), Air (Hawa), and Fire (Naar), are bricks of human structure and have their own temperament. After mixing and interaction of these principle elements in a particular ratio, a new structure comes into existence having its own temperament (Mizaj).

Mizaj (Temperament) of each and every individual varies widely as per composition as well as other surrounding factors and circumstances. Normal temperament is defined as a condition in which a person survives comfortably with all symptoms of healthy life.

Akhlaat (Humors) are liquid components of body which run through different channels inside the body and provide nutrition to the whole tissues of the body and maintain normal health. These humors have been named, according to their colour as Dam (Blood), Balgham (Phlegm), Safra (Yellow bile) and Sauda (black bile), which are red, white, yellow and black in colour respectively. Equilibrium of these humors is mainly responsible for health. Any alteration/deviation in quality or quantity from optimum position may lead to disease.

A'zaa (Organs) are solid components of the body which are composed of different types of tissues. Organs collectively form a system. Through these organized systems, body performs its routine activity. Certain organs are specified as vital organs (A,zaa-e-Raeesah) of the body which include Heart, Brain, Liver, Testes/ Ovaries and these are responsible for vital functioning of the body and play major role in continuity and propagation of life.

Arwah (Pneuma) are the gaseous components of the body mainly consisting of Naseem (Oxygen), which runs in the body through blood in dissolved form. It is the basic source of life, which provides energy for all body activities.

Quwa (Faculties of Power) are nothing but ability to perform. All organs have been assigned a particular type of action on the basis of their nature and compositions. The main four faculties of power are Quwwat-e-Haiwaniyah, Quwwat-e-Nafsaaniyah, Quwwat-e-Tab'iyah and Quwwat-e-Tanaasuliyah and the four vitals organs i.e. Heart, Brain, Liver, Testes/ Ovaries are responsible for these powers respectively.

Afa'al (Functions) are bodily activities essential for fulfilling the objectives of the body. [The organs and also testimony perform these to the presence of power in them.]





Pharmacotherapy

Unani System of Medicine emphasizes on maintaining health by natural ways and means through change in life style, regulation of diet, regular exercise, normal sleeping habits and avoiding factors, which may adversely affect the quality of life.

In conditions, where these procedures are not adequate in correcting the alterations in health, Pharmacotherapy or treatment through drugs is recommended. Some medicines are processed in natural way before use.

The Unani Materia Medica includes more than 2700 single or natural drugs. These drugs are classified into the following groups according to their origin.

Nabaati (Having plant origin)

These are either parts of plants e.g. seeds, roots, flowers, stem fruits, leaves, barks, galls, latex, exudates or the entire plant as such.

Haiwaani (Having animal origin)

Drugs of animal origin can either be animal products like milk, urine or animal parts such as hoofs and nails, hairs, flesh, organs, fats or entire animal e.g. crab, scorpion, earthworm etc.

Ma'dini Advia (Having mineral origin)

Minerals existing in nature are also used for therapeutic purposes and consist of ores, metals and precious stones, salts, stones, clay etc.

The drugs are processed with the following objectives:

1. For cleaning

2. For altering their potency

3. To convert into consumable form

4. For preservation

5. For minimising the dose.

The processes involved in cleaning are: -

1. Tasweel (Washing with water for cleaning)

2. Tasfiya (Sieving)

3. Argha (Defrothing)

4. Maghsool (Washing)

5. Aqla –Burnt to ash, soaked in water, strained and water evaporated e.g. Jawakhaar, Shora Qalmi

The processes involved in preservation are: -

1. Taqteer (Distillation)-Drugs are preserved through distillation e.g. Arq-e- Gulab,Keora.

2. Tajfeef (Drying)-Drugs are dried in sun, shade or flame to preserve, e.g amla, behi, narjeel, zanjabeel, etc.

3. Usarah (Juice)- Usarah is obtained to preserve the drug.eg usarah-e-afsanteen, Usarah-e- asl-us-soos.

4. Murabba (Jelly)- drug is preserved in sugar syrup eg Murabba-e-behi, Murabba-e-amla, and Murabba-e-seb.

5. Rub (Concentrated Juice)-Juice is concentrated to preserve the drug e.g. Rubb-e-behi, Rubb-e-seb

The processes involved in altering the potency of the drug are specific to that drug. Examples of some of the drugs processed are:-

1. Silajit

2. Shangraf

3. Sulphur

4. Turbud

5. Honey

6. Licorice

While treating a patient, a Hakim (Unani Physician) follows certain principles, which are based upon the Kaifiyaat (character) of the drug employed for treatment, with relation to the disease. Ilaj-bil-Zid is treatment through drugs having opposite temperament is the most commonly followed principle. Apart from this Ilaj-bil-Misl is treatment with drugs of same temperament as of disease and least commonly practiced method is Ilaj-bil-Badl which is treatment by using the organ affected e.g. eating liver in liver disease.

Kaifiyaat (character) of drugs are given below: -

1. Haar (Hot)

2. Baarid (Cold)

3. Ratab (Wet)

4. Yaabis (Dry)

Of the above mentioned the first two are active in nature, whereas the last two are passive. These Kaifiyaat in combination with each other result in the temperament of the drug which is a new entity e.g. Haar Ratab (Hot & Wet), Haar Yaabis (Hot & Dry), Baarid Ratab (Cold & Wet), and Baarid Yaabis (Cold & Dry).

Drugs have been classified into four grades according to their intensity: -

1. Darja Awwal (Grade I) - Medicines which, after metabolism alter the physiological condition of the body either in terms of temperature, functioning or behavior a little above the normal limits.

2. Darja Doyam (Grade II) - Medicines which, after metabolism alter the physiological condition of the body either in terms of temperature, functioning or behavior in partially abnormal limits

3. Darja Soyam (Grade III) - Medicines which, after metabolism alter the physiological condition of the body markedly.

4. Darja Chaharum (Grade IV) - Fatal Drugs/Poisons.

These are further sub-divided into initial, middle and last levels. Few drugs have been described as Mo'tadil (Neutral) in which, none of the above-mentioned kaifiyaat (character) predominate, but it closely resembles the normal human temperament.

The drugs are formulated into solid preparations e.g. Majoon, Kuhal, Marham, Qurs, etc, liquid preparations e.g. Sharbat, Joshanda, Ma-ul-Asl, Mazmaza etc & gaseous preparations e.g. Inkebaab, Shamoom, Lakhlakha.

These drugs again can be used internally or externally

a) Solid preparation for internal use e.g. Firzaja, Safoof, Laooq, Hab, Khamira, etc.

b) Solid preparation for external use e.g.Zimaad, Kajal, Sanoon, etc.

c) Liquid preparation for internal use e.g. Ma-ul-Jubn, Sharbat, Sikanjbeen, etc

d) Liquid preparation for external use e.g. Aabzan, Natool, Dalook, Huqna, and Ghargharah etc.

e) Gaseous preparation for internal use e.g. Lakhlakha, Shamoom etc.

f) Gaseous preparation for external use e.g. Wajoor, Inkebab etc.

There are certain drugs and forms of compounds specific for a system e.g.

1. Digestive System - Amla, Filfil Siyah, Zeera, Ajwain, Mako, Kasni, etc. Jawarish at are specifically used in gastric disorders.

2. Respiratory System- Asl-us-soos, Gaozaban, Unnab, Sapistan, Behdana, Badiyan, etc. Most of the gaseous preparations as well as Laooqs are specific for respiratory system.

3. Cardiovascular System- Abresham, Kafoor, Sandal, Zafran. Generally Majoon and Khamira are specific preparations for cardiovascular disorders.

4. Central Nervous System- Halela, Balela, Amla, Asgand, Azaraqi, Afiyoon, Bhang, etc. khamira and Itreefal are generally specific for Central Nervous system.

5. Genital system- Khurma, Piyaaz, Supari, Musli, Tudri, Behmanain, etc. Laboob are usually reserved for disorders pertaining to males and preparations like Firzajah, Humool for disorders pertaining to females.

While treating chronic diseases, the state of the Madda-e-Fasida (waste material) is to be kept in consideration. In this regard drugs used, perform the following two functions: -

1. Nuzj (preparation of the atmosphere in the body for easy excretion of morbid material)

2. Tanqiya (evacuation of morbid material)

These two usually follow each other but one may be carried out alone depending upon the state of the Madda-e-Fasida (waste material) and the chronicity of the disease. Tanqiya (evacuation) takes place through different excretory channels of the body namely Ishaal (purgation), Qai (emesis), Idraar-e Baul (urination), Tareeq (perspiration) and Fasd (venesection) etc.





Dietotherapy

Dietotherapy seeks to restore the imbalance in the body due to errant lifestyles. Unani system of Medicine lays rules for a balanced lifestyle, which revolves around six essential factors. Noncompliance with these principles leads to an errant lifestyle and ultimately leads to disease. Diet is an important component of these essential factors. The Unani system of medicine believes that a physician is not the healer but an assistant to nature Tabiyat (physique) of the body, which is the true healer hence the diet should be in accordance with it. Diets have been mentioned according to various stages of life to maintain the digestive system at its best.

All substances consumed by humans are divided into the following categories:

1. *Ghiza* (Diet)
2. *Ghiza-e-dawaee* (Nutritive medicine)
3. *Dawa-e-ghizaee* (Medicines having nutritive value)
4. *Dawa* (Drugs)
5. *Sammiyat* (Poisons)

1. *Ghiza* (Diet) – Diet is described as a substance that does not cause any change in the body but is changed by the body in a form, which is readily acceptable to it, for the nutritional value.

2. *Ghiza-e-dawaee*(Nutritive medicine) -These are the diets which have medicinal properties e.g. Onion, Garlic, and Almond.

3. *Dawa-e-ghizaee* (Medicinal nutrition) - These are the medicinal substances which have some nutritional value along with the medicinal benefits.

4. *Dawa* (Drug) - Drugs are defined as substances that cause change in the body and are not affected by the body itself.

5. *Sammiyat* (Poisons) - Poisons are substances that cause harmful changes in the normal functioning of the body and in extreme cases may lead to the death of an individual.

Instructions for diet with regard to treatment: -

1. *Tark-e-ghiza* (Abstinence from diet): -In this type of treatment complete abstinence from diet is prescribed to facilitate Tabiyat (physique) in combating the disease. This method is adopted when the patient has enough stamina during the severe stages of the disease.

2. *Taqleel-ul-ghiza* (Decreased diet): - The quantity of the diet is decreased either in quantity or quality, so that the patient's energies are maintained and Tabiyat (physique) also gets aided in the process of evacuation of Madda-e-fasida (waste material) and eradication of disease from the body.

This is further divided into two categories:

(i) *Taqleel-bil-Kaifiyat* (Bulky diet) – Prescribed diet is rich in cellulose and less in nutrition. This type of diet does not distract Tabiyat (physis) from digestion, when it is busy in the process of healing. On the contrary it aids it by satiating hunger. This type of diet includes vegetables, melons and watermelon, etc

(ii) *Taqleel-bil-Kammiyat* (Skimpy diet) – Prescribed diet that is high in nutrient content and is less bulky. These provide energy to the Tabiyat (physis) and are given in cases of extreme debility to patients who cannot digest bulky diets as well as in hypervolemic conditions. These are usually given in cases of acute diseases. e.g. half boiled egg.

With respect to absorption, the diet has been classified into following categories and while planning a diet for the patients these points may be taken into account: -

1 *Saree-un-nufuz* (Rapidly absorbing diet) – This type of diet after digestion, is easily absorbed by the body e.g. honey, alcohol. This is administered in cases of excessive debility and during illness as the body can readily utilize them

2 *Batee-un-nufuz* (Slowly absorbing diets) – This type of diet takes much time to absorb due to its complex and lengthy metabolic process which is difficult to absorb after metabolism for e.g. Spinach,Radish,Carrot.

According to kaimoos (chime), which ultimately affects the viscosity of blood the diet is again classified into the following categories.

1 *Ghiza-e-Raqeeq* (Liquid diet) – This type of diet produces less viscous blood after metabolism e.g. Juice, Soups, wheat porridge.

2 *Ghiza-e-Ghaleez* (Solid diet) - This type of diet produce more viscous blood after metabolism e.g. solid/semisolid preparations of meat and vegetable. This type of diet is beneficial to those doing physical labour.

Food items like any other substances too possess a temperament hence the diet of individuals should be planned accordingly e.g. people with Balghami Mizaj (Phlegmatic temperament) should take hot and dry foods like chicken, egg, onion, garlic, bitter gourd, fenugreek, grapes, walnuts, cloves, saffron, alcohol, etc, while those with Saudavi Mizaj (Melancholic temperament) should take hot and moist food items like mutton, liver, ginger, spinach, mangoes, almonds, pistachios, peaches, banana, wheat, milk, cheese, honey, sugar and salt. People with Damvi Mizaj (Sanguine temperament) should take cold and dry food items like cabbage, cauliflower, tomato, potato, beans, all sour fruits, apples, coconut, peanuts, maize, corn, peas, egg white, yogurt, tea, coffee, pickles, tamarind and vinegar. Safravi Mizaj (Choleretic temperament) people should take cold and moist foods like cucumber, ladyfinger, lettuce, beetroot, pear, fig, watermelon, litchi, rice, milk, coriander, cardamom, sugar cane juice, citrus fruits ice creams and milk shake.

There are certain principles as to *'How foods should be taken'* these include:

 The food items which are easily digestible should not be mixed with the food items which are digested slowly by the body e.g. milk and fish, pulses and mutton.

 At the time of taking food, the person should not mentally engage in other activities.

 Food should be eaten in a quite and settled atmosphere. It is better to sit down and eat and abstain when the stomach is upset.

 Food should be taken only when hungry at least at 5-6 hrs interval. Nothing should be eaten between meals.

 The food should be chewed properly.

 Water should not be taken in large quantities just after meals but after a gap of 2 hrs, water can be taken in reasonable amount.

 After lunch "Qailoola" (Short nap) is advisable for better digestion and restoration of energy..

 Physical labour should be avoided immediately after meals.





Health Preservation (Hifzaan-e-Sehat)

Unani system of medicine recognizes the influences of surroundings and ecological conditions on the state of health of human beings. There are seven factors called Umoor-e- Tabiyah which are responsible for the existence of the human body and they are considered responsible for human life, these Umoor-e- Tabiyah (factors) make a human body and a loss of anyone will result in death. Equilibrium in these Umoor e Tabiyah (principles) is essential for healthy human body and a loss of anyone will result in death. (Hippocrates).

In Unani system of medicine great reliance is placed on Tahahffuz (prevention) from diseases and Baqa-e-Sehat (preservation of health) has been defined under Asbaab-e-sitta zarooria (six essential pre-requisites). These six factors essentially influence each and every individual and all mental and physical diseases are due to their imbalance. To live a good healthy long life, it is necessary to maintain the equilibrium between these factors. A balanced relationship between these factors keeps the Humors and Temperament on the right track.

ASBAAB-E- SITTA ZAROORIA (Six essential factors)

1. HAWA (Environmental Air)

2. MAKOOL WA MASHROOB (Food and Drinks)

3. HARKAT WA SAKOON BADNI (Physical Movement and Repose)

4. HARKAT WA SAKOON NAFSANI (Psychic Movement and Repose)

5. NAUM WA YAQZA (Sleep and wakefulness)

6. EHTABAAS WA ISTAFRAAGH (Retention of nutritive material and regular excretion of waste materials)

1. HAWA (Environmental Air)

Fresh and clean air is essential for a good health. Therefore it is essential to keep surrounding environment clean. Air is the source of life and also provides the source of activation of energies to form body fluids and maintain life" Ibn-e- Sina.
The air we breathe also play an important role in maintaining the body homeostasis. We are aware that polluted air is one of the important factors for various respiratory diseases like Bronchial Asthma, Chronic bronchitis etc.

2. MAKOOL WA MASHROOB (Food and Drinks)

It is important to maintain quality and quantity of food and drink. A balanced diet and drinks according to temperament is essential for health. The quality and quantity of humors produced depend on the food taken by an individual. A major percentage of diseases occur due to mismanagement and imbalanced diet intake.

3. HARKAT WA SAKOON BADNI (Physical Movement and Repose)

It should be balanced. Regular body movement is important for utilization of stored energy and rest is important for regaining the energy lost.

4. HARKAT WA SAKOON NAFSANI (Psychic Movement and Repose)

Excessive mental work and exertion or inaction of mental powers both are injurious to health. Therefore Unani physicians recommend a balance between mental movement and repose through rest or.

5. NAUM WA YAQZA (Sleep and wakefulness)

a balance between sleep and staying awake is must to maintain health. Excess as well as lack of sleep leads to illness. Sleep rejuvenates the body physically and mentally. Wakefulness allows a person to perform activities.

6. EHTABAAS WA ISTAFRAAGH (Retention of nutritive material and regular excretion of waste materials)

Retention of healthy nutrients in the body and excretion and evacuation of waste product is essential for the maintenance of good health. If body is not able to retain nutritive ingredients as in mal absorption it results in various illnesses. Similarly, evacuation and cleansing of morbid and putrid humors are also important factors in maintenance of health. Unani Physicians gives more stress on Istafragh-e- madda (evacuation of morbid humors) when treating a disease.

Tips for the preservation of health

- Ghiza (Diet), should be adequate in terms of quantity and quality and regularity of timing should be maintained
- Atmospheric Air should be clean
- Negative emotions should be avoided (Awaariz e Nafsania))
- Excretion of the Fuzlat (waste products)





Regimental Therapy(ILAJ-BIT-TADBEER)

Ilaj-Bit-Tadbeer (Regimental therapy) is one of the four methods of treatment in the Unani system of medicine. The other three methods are Ilaj-Bil-Ghiza (Dietotherapy) Ilaj-bil-Dawa (Pharmacotherapy) and Ilaj-bil-Yad (Surgery).

Literally Tadbeer is an Arabic word meaning Regimen (Systemic plan) whereas Ilaj means therapy or treatment. So Ilaj-Bil-Tadbeer means treatment through regimen, which is a method, through which care of the sick person and maintenance of general health is performed with the help of certain procedures, tools and equipments described by eminent Unani physicians e.g. Buqrat (Hippocrates), Jalinoos (Galen), Zakaria Razi (Rhazes), Ibne Sina (Aviccena) and Abu-al-Qasim Zahrawi (Abulcassis)

Ilaj-Bil-Tadbeer is used independently or in combination with other methods of treatment like Ilaj bil Dawa (Pharmacotherapy), Ilaj Bil ghiza (Dietotherapy) and Ilaj Bil Yad (Surgery). Ilaj-Bil Tadbeer (Regimental Therapy) consists of Hijamat (cupping), Fasd (venesection), Taleeq (leeching), and Kai (cauterization).

The following are the different types of methods used for the treatment:

1. RIYAZAT (Exercise)

2. DALAK (Massage or Friction)

3. TAKMEED (Fomentation)

4. NUTOOL (Pouring of medicated lukewarm water on affected part)

5. ZIMAAD Wa TILA (Ointment and Liniment)

6. TAREEQ (Sweating)

7. IDRAR-E-BAUL (Diuresis)

8. HAMMAM (Bath)

9. ISHAAL (Purgation)

10. QAI (Emesis)

11. HUQNA (Enema)

12. IMALA (Diversion of morbid material)

13. HIJAMAT (Cupping)

14. FASD (Venesection)

15. TALEEQ (Leeching)

16. KAI (Cauterization)

Each of the above mentioned methods have been briefly explained below along with their broad indications.

Riyazat (Exercise):- Riyazat is a voluntary movement with the purpose of Tanqiya-e-Mavad (evacuation of waste material) for an individual. It plays an important role not only in maintaining good health and prevention of diseases but in curing certain ailments as well.

The objective of performing Riyazat are enumerated below:

To improve Istehala (metabolism) for proper functioning of body.

 To remove waste products from the body.

 To tone up individual organs

 To maintain or improve flexibility, co-ordination and balance of the musculoskeletal system and thus strengthen the body as a whole.

 To relieve anxiety, insomnia and depression.

Dalak (Massage or Friction):- Dalk is a systematic manipulation of body tissues with the hands. Several varieties of Dalk have been recommended in Unani system of Medicine e.g. Dalak e sulb (hard), Dalak e layyan (soft), etc. prolonged or moderate massages. Hard friction or massage is Mufatteh-e-Sudad (deobstruent) and makes the body firm. Soft massage is sedative and relaxes the body while prolonged massage reduces the fat of the body; moderate massage develops the body as well as improves and maintains blood circulation of the particular organ; rough friction with a rough cloth enhances vasodilation of the particular organ etc

The objective of performing Dalk are enumerated below:

 In the premature infants, it is found to enhance weight gain and females who were given massage therapy during labour have less agitation, faster delivery and less post partum psychosis.

 Relief from symptoms of anxiety, tension, depression, insomnia and stress as well as back pain, headache, muscles pain and some form of chronic pain.

Takmeed (Fomentation):- Takmeed is the process, which keeps the body or part of the body warm.

The objective of performing Takmeed are enumerated below

 To relieve localized or generalized pain.

 To subside the inflammatory conditions.

 To increase the penetration of massage lotion.

Nutool (Pouring of medicated water):- Natool (Pouring of medicated water) is a procedure in which the affected part is washed by a stream of water or medicated decoction from a height. Natool (Irrigation) is done with the purpose of acceleration of Ikhraaj-e-mawaad (excretion of morbid material) and Tabdeel-e-Mizaj-e- a'za (alteration of the temperament of an organ)

The objective of performing Nutool are enumerated below

- To disperse the matter from affected part.
- To alter the temperamental state of the organ.
- To achieve the astringent effect
- To relieve several chronic diseases like Paralysis, Sinusitis, Salpingitis, Arthritis, mastitis, Sleeplessness, Migraine, meningitis, Depression, Tension, Polio and even certain mental disorders.

Zimaad/ Tila (Medicated Paste/ Liniments):-

Tila (Liniments): a kind of medicated oil used externally for massage whereas

Zimaad (medicated paste): semisolid preparations of the crude drugs in powder forms used for local application.

The objectives of Zimaad/ Tila are given below:

- To combat pain of a particular organ e.g. Suda'a (headache), Waja us sadr (chest pain) etc.
- To cure swelling of a particular organ e.g. Kabid (liver), Tihaal (spleen) etc.

Tareeq (Sweating):-Tareeq (Sweating or diaphoresis) is the process to acceelrate the secretions of the sweat glands of the skin.

The objectives of Tareeq are given below:

- To excrete the Mawaad-e-Fasida (waste matter) from the skin, blood and other parts of the body
- To reduce the Hararat-e-Mufrit (excessive heat).
- To transfer the morbid matter (Imala-e- Mawaad)
- To purify blood
- To improve dermal nutrition and enhance body texture.

Idrar-e-baul (Diuresis):- Idrar-e-baul (Diuresis) is one of the important process for evacuation. Specific methods as well as drugs have been mentioned in classical Unani literature to achieve the target.

The objectives of Idrar-e-baul are given below:

- To excrete poisonous matters, waste products and excess of humours through urine.
- To purify blood and evacuate deranged humours.
- To cure diseases of heart.
- To cure hepatic ailments.
- To cure pulmonary diseases as well as renal disorder.

Hammam (Bath):- It is a place used for bathing, consisting of several rooms with one room leading to the other with specific provisions and conditions customized according to the disease to be treated.

The objectives of Hammam are given below:

- To reduce Lazoojat-e-Akhlat (viscosity of the humors).
- To improve health of the debilitated individuals
- To strengthen body
- To cure obesity
- To increase Hararat-e-Ghariziya (innate heat of the body).
- To improve Istehala (metabolism).
- To evacuate waste products through skin.
- In the treatment of Falij (paralysis) and Zubool (muscular wasting)

Ishaal (Purgation):-

Ishaal is the process used for expulsion of the waste matter through the bowels.

The objectives of Ishaal are given below:

- To resolve the morbid matter.
- To activate the derivative effect.
- To achieve antispasmodic and detoxicating effect.

Qai (Emesis):-Qai (emesis) is the evacuation of gastric contents through mouth. The main purpose of vomiting is to eliminate toxic/morbid material from the gastro-intestinal tract.

The objectives of Qai are given below:

- To cure disease like Sudaa' (Headache), Shaqeeqa (Migraine), Iltehaab-e-Lauzatain

 To resolve (Tonsillitis).

 To cure Zaat-ur-Riya (Pneumonia).

 To cure Zeequn Nafs Shu'bi (Asthma).

 To cure mental disorders, e.g. Junoon (Mania) and Maali Kholia (Melancholia).

Huqna (Enema):-

Huqna (enema) is an excellent process for the removal of superfluities from intestine. In which, liquefied drugs are introduced per rectum by an instrument. This is one of the best methods for elimination of vitiated humors and waste material from the intestine.

The objectives of huqna are given below:

 To get rid of the superfluities from intestine.

 To relieve kidney and bladder pain.

 To resolve inflammatory condition of the adjacent organs.

 To relieve colic pain.

 To relieve constipation particularly in the case of intestinal atony.

Imala (Diversion of morbid material):-

Imala means 'diversion' of matter from one part of the body to another. For this purpose, different techniques are used for treatment of conditions where Imtala-e-Damvi (hyperemia) causes certain problems.

Through this method, the flow of matter is diverted to the other side. As a result, the congestion of the affected part is reduced in a natural way.

The objectives of Imala are given below:

 To relieve pain and nervous irritability.

 To relieve burning sensation.

 To relieve the Qai-e-Hawamil (hyperemesis gravidarum).

 To dissolve (subside) inflammation.

 To dissolve lipoma and tumours.

 To absorb fluids or matter accumulated in hypodermic spaces or cavities.

Hijamat (Cupping):-

Hijamat (cupping) is a method used for local evacuation or diversion of morbid humors in which a horn is attached to the surface of the skin of the diseased part through which

negative pressure is created by vacuum. The vacuum is created by the introduction of heat or suction.

Cupping is divided into two categories

1. Hijamat bilshurt i.e. cupping with bloodletting

2. Hijamat bilashurt i.e. cupping without bloodletting

The objectives of Hijamat are given below:

 Istifragh (evacuation) of morbid matters

 Imala(diversion) of matter from one part of the body to another

Fasd (Venesection/Blood letting):-

Fasd is a procedure in which an incision is given to any of the superficial veins, and blood, containing Madda-e-Fasida (waste material) is allowed to flow. The purpose is evacuation of Madda-e-Fasida (waste material). It removes excess humours in the same proportion as present in the blood vessels or the abnormal humour or both. It is applied for purification of vitiated humors in Sarsaam (Meningitis), Zaat-ur-Riya (Pneumonia), Zaat-ul-janb (Pleurisy), Irqun Nisaa (Sciatica), Niqras (Gout), Waja-ul Mafasil (Rheumatic Arthritis), Subat Coma, Maalekholia (Melancholia), Khunaaq-e-wabaai (Diphtheria), Bawaseer (Piles), Nisyaan (Amnesia), Waja'-ul-Qalb (Angina Pectoris) etc.

The objectives of Fasd are given below:

 To maintain normal volume of blood in people who are predisposed to develop the diseases due to excess of blood.

 To stimulate Istehala (metabolism).

 To check Kasrat-e-Tams (menorrhagia) and Ru'af (epistaxis).

 To cure Humma-e- Ajaamiya (malaria) and splenic disorders, Bawaseer-e-Damvi (haemorrhoids), Waram-e-Khusiya (orchitis), Iltehab-e-Rahem (metritis), Jarb-o-Hikka (scabies and pruritis), Khuraj (boils),Iltehab-e-Kabid (hepatitis).

Taleeq (Leeching):-

Taleeq is a unique method of removal of Mawaad-e-Fasida (morbid matters). Leeching draws blood from deeper tissues. The selected point of treatment should be washed with a solution of borax and rubbed until get red. Leeches should be washed first and then applied. A little clay or blood should be smeared in the selected point to enable them stick better.

fter achieving the target and when they get distended, leeches should be detached by dusting salt borax or the ashes of burnt cloth, wool or sponge.

The objectives of Taleeq are given below:

 To cure Sa'fa (baldness and favus), Qooba (ringworm), Mawad-e-Fasida (bad matter), saleel (moles), filariasis(Da-ul-feel), meningitis(Sarsaam), pneumonia(Zaat-ur-riya)

Kai (Cauterization):-

Cauterization is an effective method of treating several conditions e.g. destructive lesions, removal of putrefactive matter and bleeding etc. Unani physicians have preferred mikwa (cauterant) made of gold.

The place to be cauterized must be visible so that the cauterization is done satisfactorily after good observation. However, in the case of deep located organs e.g. mouth, nose and anus, suitable speculum is required. It should be coated with talcum and Armenian bole, soaked in vinegar, wrapped with a piece of cloth. The speculum should be subsequently cooled with rose water or several other juices

The objectives of Kai are given below:

 To prevent the spread of putrefaction

 To alter the cold temperament or to rectify the temperament of a particular organ

 To disperse and remove the putrefactive matters, firmly adherent to the particular organ

 To arrest haemorrhage as it retains the flow of blood

 To prevent the accumulation of catarrhal matter





Frequently Asked Questions

1. What is Unani System of Medicine?
2. What are the fundamentals of Unani medicine?
3. What is *Tabiyat*?

4. What is *Mizaj*?
5. What is Theory of *Akhlaat*?
6. What are *Asbaab-e- Sitta Zarooriya*?
7. What are modes of treatment in Unani?
8. What does Sanguine Temperament mean?
9. What does Phlegmatic Temperament mean?
10. What does Choleric Temperament mean?
11. What does Melancholic Temperament mean?
12. What is *Su- e- Mizaj*?
13. What is meant by *Ilaj Bil Dawa*?
14. What are the methods of diagnosis in Unani medicine?

1. What is Unani System of Medicine?

The Unani system of Medicine is a science, which discusses the health and diseased condition of the human body in all preventive, promotive and curative aspect. The basic concepts of this system presented by Hippocrates, in 460 BC. It is based on these main concepts that Homeostasis of the Human body maintained by-

1. Akhlaat (Humours) & body fluids.
2. Proportionate equilibrium of three matter in body
3. Umoor-e- tabaiya (Natural factors) and six essential causes of health& diseases.

These are governed by Tabiyat (physis). The Tabiyat (physis) not only maintain the Mizaj of the body'but also combate the disease and bring back the body in natural state. This theory spread in the entire world by a Roman Physician Galen (Jaalinoos) in 201AD.and an Arabic Physician Avicenna (Ibn-e-Sina) 10th century pick-up the Unani medicine and provided much scientific basis. It is being practiced in India since the 13th century.

2. What are the fundamentals of Unani medicine?

The fundamentals of Unani medicine are.
1- Umoor-e-Tabiyyah (Basic Elements of Life)- These
are *Arkaan* (elements), *Mizaaj* (temperament), *Akhlaat* (humors), *Aaza* (organ), *Arwaah* (

Pneuma), *Quwa* (Faculties of Power) and *Af'al* (actions). The Human body stand by these factors, alteration in these may alter the functioning of the body.
2-Trimatter theory. 1-solid. 2-Liquid and 3-gaseous. The entire Universe made up by these three matters, so Human body also formed in that way.
3-Asbaabe Sitta Zarooriya (six essential factors).

These six essential causes are responsible for the health as well as disease of the body.

1-Hawa (Air)
2- Maakool wa mashroob (Food & drink)
3- Harkat wa Sokoon-e-Badani (physical movement & repose),
4- Harkat wa Sokoon-e-Nafsani (mental movement & repose),
5- Naum wa Yaqza (sleeping habits),
6- Ihtebas wa Istifragh (retention & evacuation)

3.What is *Tabiyat*?

Unani medicine describes the concept of Tabiyat (Medicatrix naturae) which is responsible for all physiological functioning of the body in healthy conditions, prevent the body from the diseases and cure the diseases by eradicating the causing substances. If tabiyat is strong then a man is not suffered from a disease easily, but if it weakens a man can fall in the disease easily.

4. What is *Mizaj*?

Unani Medicine is based on the Greece philosophy according to which, human body is made up of the four categories of elements i.e. Arz (Earth), Ma` (Water), Hawa (Air), and Naar (Fire) which have a particular Temperaments (Kaifiyat) i.e. Cold and Hot as active qualities and Wet and Dry as passive qualities. After mixing and interaction of four categories of elements a new compound having a new composition of the above said four qualities comes in existence. This new quality (Kaifiyat) is known as Temperament. Each and every material related to human health and disease, has been classified accordingly

5.What is Theory of *Akhlaat*?

Theory of Akhlaat (Humoral theory) is the other distinguished feature of Unani medicine conceived by Hippocrates (460BC). According to this theory, the human body consists of three types of materials: Solids which are named as organs (A'zaa), Liquids which are named as Humours (Akhlaat) and gaseous matter named as Arwaah (pneuma). Akhlaat are divided into four groups namely Dam (Blood), Balgham (Phlegm), Safra (Yellow Bile) and Sauda (Black Bile). These humours are responsible for

nourishment and over all body activities for which optimum qualitative and quantitative balance is necessary. Therefore Hippocrates defined health and disease as: Optimum balance in quality and quantity of humors is health and disease is nothing but derangement of these humors either in quality or in quantity or both. The humors also assigned a particular temperament as dam is hot and wet, balgham is cold and wet, safra is hot and dry and sauda is cold and dry.

6.What are *Asbaab-e- Sitta Zarooriya*?

Six essential factors have been described in Unani Medicine as Asbaab-e- Sitta Zarooriya, which play key role in maintenance and promotion of health, and if these factors are followed as per instructions health is maintained otherwise health problems may appear. These six essential factors are as follows:
1. Hawa (Air)
2.Maakool o Mashrub (Food and Drink)
3.Naum o Yaqza (Sleep and Wakefulness)
4.Istefraaagh wa Ehtabas (Evacuation and Retention)
5.Harkat wa sukoon e Badani (Physical activity and repose)
6.Harkat wa Sukoon e Nafsani (Mental activity and Repose)

7.What are modes of treatment in Unani?

As for as treatment is concerned, these are divided into four classes:

1- *Ilaj bil Ghiza* (Diet therapy)
2- *Ilaj bil Tadbeer* (Regimental Therapy)
3- *Ilaj bil dawa* (Pharmacotherapy)
4- *Ilaj bil Yad* (Surgery)
Although it is recommended to treat diseases first with the help of Diet and Regimental therapies and if not responding, it may be treated by next line. But it is experienced that more than one therapies may be applied simultaneously depending on the nature and severity of the disease.

8.What does Sanguine Temperament mean?

Sanguine Temperament – Belongs to Air element, a fair with muddy complexion, full muscular development, large full veins and a large pulse typifies it. These are confident, positive people who are rarely anxious. They are very prone to involve themselves with physical excesses and as a result they often suffer from injuries and their sequels. This type has also been called the 'Muscular' temperament

9.What does Phlegmatic Temperament mean?

Belongs to Water element and displays a fair complexion, light hair, general softness and laxity of tissues and a pulse that is soft and wide. Because of the excessive metabolic activity of immune system, heat tends to be drawn inwards and the exterior is cold; hence people of this types tend to feel the cold the acutely. The Phlegmatic type is slow and sluggish, apathetic and not readily excited, and easily becomes flabby and overweight. This type has also been called the 'Lymphatic' temperament

10.What does Choleric Temperament mean?

Belongs or Fire element and is characterized by a slim build and by much nervous activity. These are passionate people, quick to become excited or angry and just as quick to forget their excitement. They live on their nerves and because of this they are susceptible to brain and nervous disorders. Their pulse tends to be sharp and quick. The skin in this type appears yellowish, and this temperament occurs often in those with brown hair. This type has also been referred to as the 'Nervous' temperament.

11.What does Melancholic Temperament mean?

Belongs to Earth element and usually has a darkish complexion and appears emaciated. Their tissues are hard and dry and their pulse is narrow and thready. This temperament is prone to frequent spells of pessimism, a gloomy state of mind with much depression

12.What is *Su- e- Mizaj*?

Su- e- Mizaj is a deviation from the normal physiological response, metabolic balance or temperament of an organ, body part or of the body as a whole, due to an adverse effect from an abnormally Warm, Dry, Moist or Cold quality, which has disrupted the functions of the Humors and produced an abnormal response of Thymos. There are four Su e Mizaj:

1. Su- e- Mizaj haar
2. Su- e- Mizaj baarid
3. Su- e- Mizaj ratab
4. Su- e- Mizaj Yaabis

13.What is meant by *Ilaj Bil Dawa*?

In Ilaj Bil Dawa (Pharmacotherapy), drugs are mainly used to cure diseases. Unani Materia Medica include more than 2700 single or natural drugs most of which are plants in origin in the form of seeds, roots, flowers, fruits, leaves, barks, galls, latex, exudates and some times plant as a whole. The second group consists drugs of animal kingdom like hoofs and nails, hairs, flesh, certain organs, fats, milk etc. and third group is mineral in nature consisting ores, metals and precious stones and these are named

as Nabaati (plant origin), Haiwaani (animal origin) and Ma' dini Advia (mineral origin drugs) respectively.

14.What are the methods of diagnosis in Unani medicine?

Diagnosis in Unani system of medicine is done through three methods.
1- Imtehan- bil- Nazar (Inspections)
2- Imtehan- bil- Lams (Palpations)
3- Imtehan- bil-Qara (Percussions)

Imtehan- bil- Nazar (Inspections)**-**In this' patients are recognized by visual method on there features from head to toe.
Imtehan- bil- Lams (Palpations)**-**This method Used to feel that what type of Malmas (feelings on touch by the hand) Specially Unani Tabeeb used the method to palapate the pulse. This was the main technique to diagnose the diseases.
Imtehan- bil-Qara (Percussions)**-**This is also used in Unani medicine.





CCRUM

The **Central Council for Research in Unani Medicine(CCRUM)** was established in the year 1978 as an Autonomous Organisation of Ministry of Health & Family Welfare, Government of India. The Council is engaged in the multifaceted research activities in Unani medicine. The areas chosen for research include clinical research, drug research, literary research and survey & cultivation of medicinal plants programme. The Council has a network of 25 research institutes/units functioning in different parts of the country. These include two Central Research Institutes of Unani Medicine - one each at Hyderabad and Lucknow, eight Regional Research Institutes of Unani Medicine – one each at Chennai, Bhadrak, Patna, Kolkata, Aligarh, New Delhi, Srinagar and Mumbai, six Clinical Research Units – one each at Allahabad, Karimganj (Assam), Bhopal, Burhanpur, Bangalore and Meerut, a Unani Medical Centre at New Delhi, four Drug Standardisation Research Units – one each at New Delhi, Lucknow, Chennai and Bangalore, a Chemical Research Unit at Aligarh and a Literary Research Institute in New Delhi is also functioning in New Delhi. The Headquarters of the Council is in New Delhi. During the past over 25 years of its existence the Council have made significant strides in its research programmes and emerged to be a major organisation of research in the country.

Under clinical research programme, the Council have taken-up clinical studies on 30 diseases some of them having national priorities. These include; Bars (Vitiligo), Nar-e-

Farsi (Eczema), Dau Sadaf (Psoriasis), Iltehab-e-Kabid (Infective hepatitis), Hasatul Kuliya Wa Masana (Renal and bladder calculus), Qarah-e-Meda wa Asna-e-Ashari (Duodenal ulcer), Ishal-e-Muzmin (Chronic diarrhoea), Ishal-e-Atfal (Infantile diarrhoea), Deedan-e-Ama (Helminthiasis), Waram-e-Kuliya (Nephritis), Rabu-e-Nazli (Tropical. pulmonary eosinophilia), Jarbul Ajfan (Trachoma), Waram-e-Lissa (Gingivitis), Kasrat-e-Tams (Menorrhagea), Sailan-ur-Rahem (Leucorrhoea), Humma-e-Ijamia (Malaria), Zusantaria Mevi (Amoebic dysentery), Humma-e-Aswad (Kala Azar, Leishmaniasis), Daul Feel (Filariasis), Ziabetus Sukari (Diabetes mellitus), Waja-ul-Mafasil (Rheumatoid arthritis), Iltehab-e-Tajaweef-e-Anf (Sinusitis), Zeequn Nafas (Bronchial asthma), Kasrat-e-Shahmuddam (Hyperlipidemia), Falij-e-Nisfi (Hemiplegia), Irq-e-Madani (Dracontiasis), Zaghtuddam Qawi (Hypertension), Muzmin Zubeh-e-Sadaria Sabit (Chronic stable angina), Bawaseer (Piles), Takassur Kuliya Muzmin (Chronic renal failure). In these diseases multifaceted studies were conducted. The Council have so far screened 120 new formulations/drugs in different diseases. Extensive clinical trials were conducted with 55 formulations/drugs that were proved effective in the preliminary screening. Out of these, studies on 30 drugs have been completed. Significant leads have been achieved in the successful treatment of some chronic diseases such as Bars (Vitiligo), Iltehab-e-Kabid (Infective Hepatitis), Zeequn Nafas (Bronchial Asthma), Iltehab-e-Tajaweef-e-Anf (Sinusitis), Waja-ul-Mafasil (Rheumatoid arthritis), Nar-e-Farsi (Eczema), Daus Sadaf (Psoriasis), Humma-e-Ijamia (Malaria), Daul Feel (Filariasis), Ishal-e-Atfal (Infantile diarrhoea), Irq-e-Madani (Guineaworm infestation) and Sailan-ur-Raham (Leucorrhoea). The council have so far developed 20 drugs. Twelve drugs have already been decoded by publishing the studies in the form of monographs. Eighteen new drugs developed by the Council have already been filed for grant of patent rights where as other 11 drugs are in the process of patenting. Besides, 24 kit medicines developed by the Council for common/seasonal ailments have also been filed for provisional patents.

A part from the therapeutic trials, the Council have also evaluated the beneficial effects of certain Unani therapies such as Munzij and Mushil therapy, Hajamat (Cupping), Leaching on scientific lines, in some of the diseases. These therapies have been proved of immense therapeutic potential in the successful treatment of some chronic diseases such as; Waja-ul-Mafasil (Rheumatoid arthritis), Irqun- Nisa (Sciatica), Zaghtuddam Qawi (Essential Hypertension), Nar-e-Farsi (Eczema) and Frost bite.

Collaborative studies with other scientific organisations of national repute and leading medical colleges and hospitals in the areas of clinical research, drug standardization and quality control, safety evaluation and toxicity studies and development of bio-active molecules are also continued. Some of these collaborative institutions are CSIR, V.B. Patel Chest Institute, New Delhi, Deccan Medical College, Hyderabad, Gandhi Medical College, Bhopal and NRDC- New Delhi

Apart from research activities treatment and Medicare facilities are also being provided for common ailments in the General OPD at the Council's clinical centers. Over two lakhs patients are treated annually. A Unani Medical Center was established by the Department of ISM&H (now Dept. of AYUSH) at the Capital's Dr. Ram Manohar Lohia Hospital, New Delhi in 1998. This center is being run by the Council. It has gained a very good public response for the treatment of different chronic disorders. A large number of cases are referred from different department of the RML, hospitals. The center has so far registered over 1,90,000 new patients. Research oriented medicare facilities were also continued in urban slums/rural and tribal pockets. Under this programme above 20,00,000 population was covered in 180 villages/rural. SC/ST pockets. Above 2,50,000 patients were benefited. With a view to reduce the morbidity particularly among school children, school health programmes are also continued at different centers.

Research on fundamental aspect of Unani medicine is continued with a view to interpret scientifically the basic concepts of the humours and temperaments. Phase-I study on the assessment of the temperament has already been completed whereas phase-II study entitled susceptibility of acquiring diseases in relation to different temperaments is in progress.

Under the drug standardisation research programme, the Council has so far been able to finalise standards for 277 single drugs and 385 compound formulations. Standards for 122 single drugs have been incorporated in the National Unani Pharmacopoeia of India. Work on development of Standard Operating Procedures (SoPs) for compound formulations has also been initiated. Besides, **48 Unani drugs** have also been studied for their pharmacopoeial standards allotted by the Department of A YUSH. Work on presence of heavy metals in Unani formulations has also been initiated in the Council's drug standardization laboratories.

Studies on the development bio-active molecules of **54 Unani formulations** are also continued in collaboration with Council for Scientific and Industrial Research (CSIR). The results reported in different samples are suggestive of immunomodulatory, antibacterial antifungal, hepato-protective activities. Besides, anti-Leishmanial, anti-oxidant, anti-filarial, anti-anxiety and anti-depressant activities.

Under **survey & cultivation of medicinal plants programme** ethno-botanical exploration of different forest areas in 11 states were conducted collecting about **59462** plants specimens. Besides **9000** folk claims have also been collected from different Tribes. A database of this information has already been developed and published in four volumes. Under experimental & large-scale cultivation of medicinal plants programme, Council has successfully cultivated about 22 important plants species on experimental basis. Agro-techniques for different plants were developed. Some of the plants such as Atrilal *(Ammi majus)*, Gulnar Farsi *(Punica grantum Linn.)* (Abortive variety) are now being cultivated on large scale. The Council has also

developed a herbal garden at Lucknow and nurseries of medicinal plants at different centers of the Council. Council has also collected 9000 folk claims out of which 6,000 claims have been published in four volumes under the titles *Medicinal Plants in Folklore of Northern India, Medicinal Plants in Folklore of Southern India, Medicinal Plants in Folklore of Bihar & Orissa, and Medicinal Plants in Folklore of Kashmir Himalayas*.

Under the **literary research programme**, the Council has brought-out translation of **52 important classical** manuscripts/books from Arabic/Persian to Urdu and other languages. Besides compilation of two books and 17 **brochureslleaflets** on different diseases have also been done. Under the Traditional Knowledge Digital Library (TKDL) project of a database on the information available in the Unani classics comprising of **77000 formulations** collected from **14 classics in 35 volumes** was developed.

The Council participated in the medical relief work during various epidemics and natural calamities and provided medicare through Unani medicines. Unani drugs proved very effective in managing different epidemics.

With a view to disseminate research information and interaction with scientific community, the Council organised two **International Seminar/Conference** on Unani Medicine, **13 National seminars, and 20 workshops**. The researchers of the Council have so far produced **1400 research papers**. These papers were presented in different seminars. About **250** research papers were also published in different Indian and International Scientific Journals. Continued medical education programmes with a view to update the knowledge organized in different disciplines.

Besides, continuing the research on national priorities and some other life style diseases concerted efforts are also continued to intervene in the new medical challenges such as, HIV/ AIDS and Cancer where the Unani Medicine can play a vital role in strengthening the immunity level thereby improving the quality of life. The address of Council website is http://www.unanimedicine.org





Glossary

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z

A'zaa	These are parts of the body and contain the energy required by them to perform their respective functions.

A’zaa-e- Raeesah	The vital organs of the body, these are important for the normalfunctioning of the body and preservation of health.these are four in no i.e. heart, liver, brain and testes/ovary.
Aasaab	Nerves.
Af’aal	Function -These are subservient of quwa.
Aghshiyah	Membrane.
Ajsaam-e-Khabeesah	Micro-organism.
Akhlaat (Humours)	These are those moist and fluid parts of the body, which areproduced after transformation, and metabolism of elements theyserve the function of nutrition, growth and repair and produceenergy for the preservation of individual and species. The rightproportion and intermixture of theses in terms of quantity andquality constitutes health and inappropriate proportion or imbalanceaccording to quality and quantity and irregular distribution leads to disease.
Alaamat(Sign & Symptom)	Symptoms Any sensation or change in bodily function that is experienced by a patient and is associated with a particular disease.
Arba’h	Four.
Arkaan (Elelments)	These are simple indivisible matters, which provide the primary components for the living and non-living. They cannot be further resolved into simpler entities.
Arz (Earth)	This is a category, which stands for solid elements.
Arz	Any disease or disorder that occurs during the course of (or because of) another disease (Complications).
Asbaab-e-Sitta Zarooriyah	Six essential factors of health without which healthy life is impossible.
Azm	Bone.

Balgham	All the white or colourless fluids of the body are called as Balgham (phlegm).
Baraaz	Faeces-Excretory product evacuated from the bowels .
Batee-un-nufuz	Substances that are slowly absorbed by the body.
Baul	Excretory by-product of the kidney (Urine).
Dalak	Kneading and rubbing parts of the body to increase circulation and promote relaxation (Massage).
Dam	The red colored fluid that circulates in the blood vessels .It is regarded as carrier of all four kinds of Akhlaat viz dam(Blood),Balgham, Safra and Sauda.
Dawa	A substance that has medicinal value and is used as drug.
Dawa-e-ghizaee	Medicinal Nutrition - medicines which have some nutritional value along with the medicinal benefits.
Ehtebaas (Retention)	This is a process of retention or preservation of material in the body.
Fasd (Blood Letting)	Blood letting from the vessels for therapeutic purposes.
Fasid Mawaad (Waste matter)	Morbid Matter.
Fuzlat	Any materials unused and rejected as worthless or unwanted (Waste product).
Ghair Taba'iyah	Condition opposing the tabiyat (pathological).
Ghaleez	Relatively dense in consistency (Viscous).
Ghiza-e-Dawaee	Nutritive Medicine-diets which have medicinal properties.
Ghiza-e-ghahleez	Food that after metabolism produces thick blood.
Ghiza-e-kaseef	Bulky Diet.
Ghiza-raqeeq	Liquid Diet.

Ghuzroof	Cartilage.
Haad	Any condition which is short and severe.
Haiwaani	Animal origin.
Hijamat (Cupping)	It is a procedure, in which vacuum is created by the application of a cup on the skin to draw blood towards the surface.
Hammam (Bath)	It is a set of rooms designed to have a bath for therapeutic purposes described classically.
Hararat-e-Ghariziyah	This is the heat/energy produced in the body , which is essential for maintenance of health.
Hararat-e-Mufrit	This refers to an increase in body temperature from its normal limits.
Harkat-o-Sakoon-e-Badni	Physical movement and physical repose.
Harkat-o-Sakoon-e-Nafsani	Psychological activity (emotion) and psychological repose.
Hawa	This is a category, which stands for gaseous elements.
Hawa-e-Muheet	The air that surrounds us (Environmental air.)
Hawa-e-Naseem	Oxygen rich air.
Hazmah	The organic process by which food is converted into substances that can be absorbed into the body. (Digestion).
Hijamat bilashurt	Cupping without scarification.
Hijamat bisshurt	Cupping with scarification.
Huqna	It is the process of giving enema for therapeutic purposes.
Idraar-e-Haiz	Propulsion of menstrual discharge.
Ilaj Bil Zid	Principle of treatment wherein the temperament of the drug is antagonist to that of the disease.

Ilaj-bil-dawa	Treatment through drugs (pharmacotherapy).
Ilaj-bil-ghiza	Treatment through diet (dietotherapy).
Ilaj-bil-yad	Treatment through surgical procedures (surgery).
Iltehaab	It a swelling that occurs in reaction to irritation, injury, or infection (Inflammation).
Imaala	Diversion of the matter from the diseased organ for therapeutic purposes.
Imtehan- bil-lams	A method of examination in which the examiner feels the size or shape or firmness or location of body part (Palpation).
Imtehan-bil-nazar	The act of examining something closely with eyes (Inspection).
Imtehan-bil-qara	Tapping a part of the body for diagnostic purposes (Percussion).
Imtelaa	Excessive accumulation of blood or other fluids in a body part (Congestion).
Insibab	This refers to being poured out.
Ishaal	The process of evacuation or excretion through bowels.
Istefragh	A process of discharging waste matter from the body either bynatural process or with the aid of drugs or certain procedure.
Istehala	Biochemical reaction of the body (metabolism).
Juz-e-badan	The food after tissue metabolism is formed into various hormones, enzymes and other proteins, which are helpful in the process of growth and repair, and becomes an integral part of the tissue or organ.
Kabid	Liver.
Kaee	Cauterisation of the body parts for therapeutic purposes (Cauterization).
Kaifiyat	Property of a substance that deals in quality.
Kammiyat	Property of a substance that deals in quantity.

Kaseef	Of comparatively great physical weight or density (Heavy).
Kaylus	When Ghiza (food) passes through primary digestion (hazm-e-ma'idi) this ghiza is transformed into kaylus (chyme), which resembles Aas-e-jau(barley water).
Lahem	Muscle.
Lateef	Of comparatively little physical weight or density (Light).
Lazoojat-e-Akhlat	Viscosity of the humors.
Ma' dini Advia	Any condition which is short and severe.
Maa'	Water.
Maa-e-Sheerein	Pure /Mineral water.
Madda	That which has mass and occupies space (Matter).
Mahaul	Surroundings.
Makool-o Mashroob	Food and drinks.
Marz	An impairment of health or a condition of abnormal functioning(Disease).
Mikwa	The instrument through which cauterization is done (cauterant).
Mizaj (Temperament)	It is a new state of a matter having quality different from that presentin the elements or compounds before coming into chemicalcombination which results from the action and reaction among thecontra try qualities and power present in the minute particles ofdifferent elements (temperament).
Mizaj-e-Baarid Ratab (Cold and Moist)	Cold and wet temperament.
Mizaj-e-Baarid Yaabis (Cold and dry)	Cold and dry temperament.

Mizaj-e-Haar Ratab (Hot and moist)	Hot and wet temperament.
Mizaj-e-Haar Yaabis (Hot and dry)	Hot and dry temperament.
Mo'tadil	Substance that is in a balanced state.
Mohalill	(Anti inflammatory)The drugs or procedures, which have a Resolvent property.
Mudir	Drugs or procedures that have evacuating property for fluids.
Mufatteh-e-Sudad	Drugs or procedures that have a deobstruent effect.
Mufrad	Existing alone or consisting of one entity (Single).
Munaffis	The drugs which have an expectorant action.
Munzij	The drugs that are used for maturing matter to a state wherein it canbe easily evacuated by the body.
Muqawwi	The drugs which increase the overall strength of the body.
Muqawwi-e-bah	The drugs which are used as Aphrodisiac.
Muqee	The drugs which are used as Emetic.
Murrakkab	Consisting of two or more substances or ingredients or elements orparts (Compound).
Mushil	Purgatives.
Musleh	The drugs which counter act the toxicity of another drug.
Mussaffi-e-dam	These are the drugs that have blood purifying property.
Mussakin-e-alam	Drugs or procedures that have an analgesic property.
Muzmin	Condition progressing slowly and persisting over a long period oftime.
Naar	It denotes matter that has been changed into heat energy.

Nabaati	Having plant origin.
Nabz (Pulse)	Pulse is the alternate expansion (inbisaat) and contraction(inqibadh) of the arteries produced by the pressure changes during systole and diastole of ventricles of the heart.
Nafsaniyaat	The study of mind and behavior in relation to a particular field of knowledge or activity (psychology).
Naum	The natural periodic suspension of consciousness during which the powers of the body are restored (Sleep).
Nuzj	The process of maturing morbid matter to a state wherein it can be easily evacuated by the body.
Qai (Vomiting)	The reflex act of ejecting the contents of the stomach through themouth. It can be either pathological or induced by certain procedures.
Qaleel-ul-ghiza	Decreased quantity of food.
Qate'	Drugs that neutralize/modify the adverse effects produced by body humours.
Qatil kirm shikam	Drugs that have a vermicidal action (anthelminthic).
Qurooh	A circumscribed inflammatory and often suppurating lesion on the skin or an internal mucous surface resulting in necrosis of tissue (Ulcer).
Quwa (Faculties)	These are the natural and specialized powers which are furnished to a living body for the performance of its specific functions.
Quwwat-e-Baserah	Visual faculty.
Quwwat-e-Hafizah	The power of retaining and recalling past experience (Memory).
Quwwat-e-Haiwaniyah	Those faculty which furnish vitality to the organs to enable them to receive Quwwat-e- Nafsaaniyah (mental power) to accomplishvarious activity of life.

Quwwat-e-Lam'sah	Tactile faculty.
Quwwat-e-Nafsaaniyah	The faculty which perform intellectual, sensory and motor functions of the body.
Quwwat-e-Saameyah	Auditory faculty.
Quwwat-e-Sha'mma	Olfactory faculty
Quwwat-e-Tanasuliyah	The faculty which ensures propagation and preservation of the species.
Quwwat-e-Zai'qah	Faculty of Taste.
Quwwat-e-Manaat	The faculty responsible for resistanceagainst disease. (Immunity)
Quwwat-e-Mudabbira-e-badan	See tabiyat
Quwwat-e-Tab'iyah (Physical power)	The faculty responsible for ingestion, digestion, absorption, transformation and assimilation of ghiza (food) and excretion of waste products and preservation of race.
Radi'	Waste and unuseful material
Raqeeq	Thin in consistency or low in density.
Ratoobat	A substance that is in liquid form.
Rebaat	Tendon.
Riyazat (Exercise)	Riyazat is voluntary movement an individual makes with one or more parts of the body to spend excess energy and to stay fit(exercise).
Ruh	It is a gaseous substance, obtained from inspired air. It helps in all metabolic activities of the body, it burns the akhlat to produce all kinds of quwa (powers) and hararat ghariziyah (innate heat). It is the source of vitality for all the organs of the body.

Sabab	A reason for an action or condition (Cause).
Safra	Bile and all yellow fluids of the body are categorized as safra.
Salaabat	This refers to hardness of tissue or organ.
Sam	Poison
	Substances that are easily absorbed by the body.
Sauda	All dark brown or black fluids of the body (melanchole).
Sehat	Health.
Shahem	Fat.
Soorat-e-nuiyah	Molecular structure.
Su'e Mizaj baarid	Imbalance of temperament wherein coldness exceeds its normal limits.
Su'e Mizaj ratab	Imbalance of temperament wherein moisture exceeds its normal limits.
Su'e Mizaj yaabis	Imbalance of temperament wherein dryness exceeds its normal limits.
Su'e-Mizaj	Imbalance of temperament.
Sudda	Material that produce obstruction in flow of fluids of the body.
Taba'iyah	Pertaining to tabiyat (physis).
Tabeeb	Helper of Tabiyat or physician.
Tabiyat (physis)	It is that energy of the body, which is essential to perform allcorrective and progressive functions of the body.
Tafarruq-e-ittesaal	This refers to any discontinuity/breach of tissue.
Taghayyur	Events that occurs when something passes from one state to another (Changes).

Takmeed	Takmeed is the process of keeping the body or particular part of the body warm through a piece of cloth (Fomentation).
Tal'een	It is a process through which laxation is induced.
Taleeq or Irsal-e-Alaq	Irsal-e-Alaq is the procedure wherein a leech is applied to the skin for therapeutic purposes (congestion).
Tanqiyah	The process of evacuating waste products from the body.
Tareeq	The process of inducing sweating for therapeutic purposes.
Tark-e-ghiza	Abstinence from food.
Tibb	Medical science.
Tihaal	Spleen.
Tila	Tila is a kind of Medicated Oil that is applied on affected part.
Tiryaaq	Antidote.
Ufoonath	Invasion of the body by pathogenic microorganisms causing inflammation. (Infection).
Umoor al Tabayiah	It deals with the nature of a thing (human body) which is comprised of seven pillars.
Urooq	Vessels
Usool-e-Ilaaj	Principles of treatment.
Waram	Swelling
Yaqza	A state of complete consciousness (awake).
Zimaad	Medicinal paste that is applied on the affected part.
Zood Hazm	Food that is easily digested.